



Atari 2600, a popular video computer system, made gaming a household affair

small selection of games included in the box, consumers could now amass libraries of games.

The advent of cartridge-based games gave rise to a number of independent game publishers. Activision was among the first third-party games developers. This was the beginning of the “8-bit era”. Intellivision, introduced by Mattel in 1980 (though part of the “8-bit era”) had a processor with 10-bit instructions, allowing for more instruction variety and speed.

Early cartridges were 2 KB ROMs for the Atari 2600 and 4K for the Intellivision. This upper limit, of course, grew steadily.